demonstrated that remote-controlled powered flight was achievable (Cuerno-Rejado, et al. 2016).

Following this, the Ruston Proctor Aerial Target (1917), also developed under Low's supervision, became one of the earliest functioning pilotless aircraft capable of maintaining controlled flight. Around the same time in the United States, Charles Kettering introduced the Kettering Bug (1918), an unmanned aerial torpedo powered by a small engine and guided by a mechanical pre-set control system. The Kettering Bug is historically recognized as a precursor to modern cruise missiles, introducing the concept of automated flight distance control and pre-programed flight paths (Valavanis, et al. 2007).

The interwar period (1920s–1930s) saw further refinement of UAV technology as military organizations continued to explore unmanned aircraft for training and target simulation. This led to the development of the De Havilland DH.82B "Queen Bee" (1935) in the United Kingdom, a radio-controlled biplane derived from the Tiger Moth trainer aircraft. The Queen Bee became the first operational and mass-produced drone, used extensively by the Royal Navy and Royal Air Force for anti-aircraft gunnery practice. Its success not only validated the reliability of radio-controlled flight but also introduced the term "*drone*," derived from its buzzing engine sound.

By the late 1930s, UAV technology had progressed from experimental prototypes to functional training and reconnaissance systems, as demonstrated by the Radioplane OQ-2 (1939) in the United States. Developed by Reginald Denny Industries, it became the first UAV to be produced on an industrial scale, marking a turning point where drones transitioned from one-off experimental machines to standardized, operational tools (Keane, et al. 2013).